

Round 1 — “The After-Party”

8:00 PM – 10:00 PM

Scene: The after-party in the courtyard. Steel drum music, glowing pool, cocktails. Paloma is supposed to give a toast at 9 PM. She doesn't show. By the end of this round, the body is found and the gates are shut.

- Arrive in linen and blowout. Be the PTA mom. Ask about families. Remember names. Speak softly — make people lean in.
- Be warm to everyone. Touch people on the arm. You are the least suspicious person in the room.
- **Check your watch every two minutes. Not subtle. Just often enough that someone counts.** (Lorraine will count out loud later.)
- **In your tote you carry a printed photo of Diego (your firstborn) — don't show it to anyone. It's tucked at the bottom.**
- **Also at the bottom of the tote:** a pre-stained handkerchief, a brown Sharpie wrapped in masking tape labeled “INSULIN” (this is your “insulin pen”), and a “burn this” note. Don't pull any of them out — they will surface when your tote is searched in Round 3.
- When the body is found, be composed. Put your arm around Pam. Check on Marco with a glance, not words.